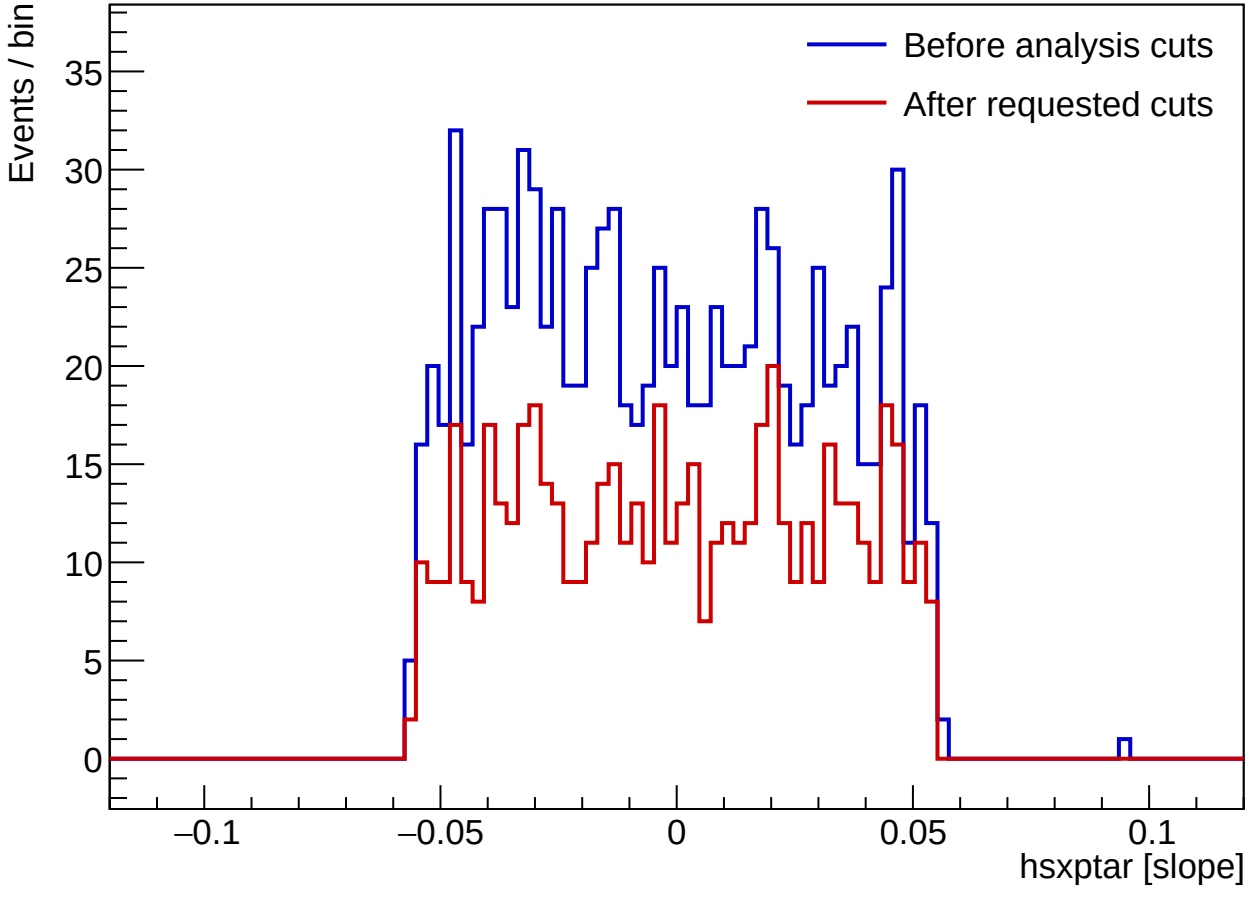rho SIMC | PROVISIONAL